COLIN KING

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EXPERIENCE

Rippling February 2024 - April 2026
Staff Software Engineer *San Francisco, CA*

- Designed and implemented a new Search architecture to reduce average query times from 3s to 100ms and expand from 2 searchable data types to over a dozen.
- Served as the Tech Lead for the Search team, expanding it from just myself to a team of 6 high-performing engineers.
- Collaborated with product and design to implement a high-quality UI for Search. Pushed for improvements in UX and UI. Set expectations with stakeholders and drove technical decision making.
- Architected a generic authz system to support pushing permission logic for Google Drive, Atlassian, and Slack permissions into OpenSearch.
- Onboarded and mentored over a dozen engineers.
- Served as the OpenSearch expert at Rippling and was consulted by teams who were adopting it.
- Data Bridge
- Events Platform

Airplane.dev January 2021 - January 2024
Founding Engineer *San Francisco, CA*

- First hire; helped grow the team from 1 to 22 employees before it was acquired by Airtable.
- Led product and engineering for Runbooks, a multi-step operations builder: ran customer research, designed the UX, built the beta solo, and led two engineers to GA in 6 months.
- Proposed and drove the company's pivot from no-code Runbooks to code-first Workflows.
- Architected a Temporal-backed durable execution runtime that let developers write long-running, multi-step workflows as plain TypeScript.
- Built much of the core Tasks platform: the build system (deploy code without a Dockerfile), Docker registry, parameter schema, environments, local development, API idempotency, V8-based JS templating language, and the first Python SDK.
- Set up foundational infrastructure and practices: e,g. migrated to infra-as-code with Pulumi, ran incident reviews, and mentored 6 engineers.

Segment July 2018 - January 2021
Senior Software Engineer *San Francisco, CA*

- Helped launch Protocols: data quality product
- Primary author of Typewriter, the open-source code-generator for type-safe analytics clients.
- Prototyped a ClickHouse-based counters system for Protocols that replaced the legacy Redis-based system, improving the reliability, granularity, and performance.
- Led full-stack development to support deploying Segment in customer VPCs.
- Developed a general-purpose ClickHouse-based system for counter-based systems that could be deployed to customer VPCs.
- Replays?

University of Maryland August 2017 - May 2018
Founder, Student Instructor *College Park, MD*

- Founded and taught 2 semesters of CMSC389L, a for-credit class on practical cloud computing with AWS.

Contrary Capital April 2017 - May 2018
Venture Partner, Engineering Lead *College Park, MD*

- Founded and lead the UMD pod of Contrary Capital, a decentralized pre-seed stage venture capital fund.
- Responsible for sourcing deals, performing due diligence, building a campus-wide network, hosting talks and events.
- Directed a 5-person team to rebrand Contrary (and contrarycap.com) for our nationwide launch in September 2017.
- Founded, hired, and lead the 3-person Contrary engineering team on various projects, including our talent platform.

Google May 2016 - August 2016
Software Engineering Intern *San Francisco, CA & Mountain View, CA*

- Singlehandedly architected a scalable system to verifiably delete and recover indexed search data on Google Cloud.

EDUCATION

University of Maryland & Cybersecurity Honors College

B.S. in Computer Science, Statistics Minor – GPA: 3.98 (magna cum laude) August 2014 - May 2017

M.S. in Computer Science – dropped out August 2017 - May 2018

HONORS AND AWARDS

- KPCB Engineering Fellow (Summer 2017, Nextdoor)
- Won more than a dozen hackathon awards including: 2nd Place at MHacks VI; 1st Place at HackTheChange; 1st Place at Damon Dash; 3rd Place at RevolutionUC